A Jubilee of People Dreaming Wildly

with poems by Mahogany L. Browne, Margarita Engle and Carrie Newcomer

This is the Honey by Mahogany L. Browne

(Pg 47) There is no room on this planet for anything less
than a miracle
We gather here today to revel in the rebellion of a silent
tongue
Every day, we lean forward into the light of our brightest
designs
& cherish the sun
Praise our hands & throats
each incantation, a jubilee of people dreaming wildly
Despite the dirt
beneath our feet
or the wind
pushing against
our greatest efforts

Soil creates things
Art births change
This is the honey
& doesn't it taste like a promise?
Where your heart is an accordion
& our laughter is a soundtrack

Friend, dance to this good song—
look how it holds our names!

Each bone of our flesh-homes sings welcome

O look at the Gods dancing
as the rain reigns against a steely skyline

Where grandparents sit on the porch & nod at the
spectacle
in awe of the perfection of their grandchildren's faces
Each small discovery unearthed in its own outpour
Tomorrow our daughters will travel the world with each
poem
& our sons will design cities against the backdrops of
living museums
Yes! Our children will spin chalk until each equation
bursts a familial tree

Rooted in miraculous possibilities
& alive

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Mahogany L. Browne
Book: This is the Honey: An Anthology of Contemporary Black Poets, Pg 47
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INTRODUCTION

That's the world I want to live in – "A jubilee of people dreaming wildly" – A world when someone says you can't do it. You do it twice and take pictures!

This collection is dedicated to those who never accepted the word "can't." Did you know that Stphen King's 1st novel was rejected by publishers 30 times? Oprah Winfrey was fired from her 1st TV job and Walt Disney was told he'd never make it because he lacked imagination and had no good ideas.

A Jubilee of People Dreaming Wildly with This is the Honey by Mahagony L. Browne, Drum Dream Girl by Margarita Engle and Liminality by Carrie Newcomer

Drum Dream Girl

On an island of music
in a city of drumbeats
the drum dream girl
dreamed

of pounding tall conga drums
tapping small *bongó* drums
and boom boom booming
with long, loud sticks
on big, round, silvery
moon-bright *timbales*.

But everyone
on the island of music

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in the city of drumbeats
believed that only boys
should play drums

so the drum dream girl
had to keep dreaming
quiet
secret
drumbeat
dreams.

At outdoor cafés that looked like gardens
she heard drums played by men
but when she closed her eyes
she could also hear
her own imaginary
music.

When she walked under
wind-wavy palm trees
in a flower-bright park
she heard the whir of parrot wings
the clack of woodpecker beaks
the dancing tap
of her own footsteps
and the comforting pat
of her own
heartbeat.

At carnivals, she listened
to the rattling beat
of towering
dancers
on stilts

and the dragon clang
of costumed drummers
wearing huge masks.

At home, her fingertips
rolled out their own
dreamy drum rhythm
on tables and chairs…

and even though everyone
kept reminding her that girls
on the island of music
have never played drums

the brave drum dream girl
dared to play
tall conga drums
small *bongó* drums
and big, round, silvery
moon-bright *timbales*.

Her hands seemed to fly
as they rippled
rapped

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and pounded
all the rhythms
of her drum dreams.

Her big sisters were so excited
that they invited her to join
their new all-girl dance band

but their father said only boys
should play drums.

So the drum dream girl
had to keep dreaming
and drumming
alone

until finally
her father offered
to find a music teacher
who could decide if her drums
deserved
to be heard.

The drum dream girl's
teacher was amazed.
The girl knew so much
but he taught her more
and more
and more

and she practiced
and she practiced
and she practiced

until the teacher agreed
that she was ready
to play her small *bongó* drums
outdoors at a starlit café
that looked like a garden

where everyone who heard
her dream-bright music
sang
and danced
and decided
that girls should always
be allowed to play
drums

and both girls and boys
should feel free
to dream.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Margarita Engle
ISBN: 978-0544102293
Publisher: Clarion Books
Date (Month/Year): March 2015

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Liminality by Carrie Newcomer

So much of what we know
Lives just below the surface.
Half of a tree
Spreads out beneath our feet.
Living simultaneously in two worlds,
Each half informing and nurturing
The whole.
A tree is either and neither
But mostly both.

I am drawn to liminal spaces,
The half-tamed and unruly patch
Where the forest gives way
And my little garden begins.
Where water, air and light overlap
Becoming mist on the morning pond.

I like to sit on my porch steps, barn jacket and boots
In the last long exhale of the day,
When bats and birds loop in and then out,
One rising to work,
One readying for sleep.

And although the full moon calls the currents,
And the dark moon reminds me that my best language
Has always emerged out of the silence,
It is in the waxing and waning

Where I most often live,
Neither here nor there,
But simply On the way.

There are endings and beginnings
One emerging out of the other.
But most days I travel in an ever present
And curious now.
A betwixt and between,
That is almost,
But not quite,
The beautiful,
But not yet.

I've been learning to live with what is,
More patient with the process,
To love what is becoming,
And the questions that keep returning.

I am learning to trust
The horizon I walk toward
Is an orientation
Not a destination
And that I will keep catching glimpses
Of something great and luminous
From the corner of my eye.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Carrie Newcomer
Book: Until Now: New Poems
ISBN: 978-1737533504
Publisher: Available Light Publishing
Date (Month/Year): August 2021

(softly – from Drum Dream Girl)
feel free to keep dreaming
quiet secret drumbeat dreams

(louder – from This is the Honey)
Nod at the spectacle

(with unbridled joy - This is the Honey)
Be a jubilee of people dreaming wildly

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